FONOM
Federation of Northern Ontario Municipalities

To: Delegation during the ROMA Conference, January 2026

From: FONOM Board

Date: January 19, 2026

Subject: Strengthening Ontario's Blue Box Program
Extending Producer Responsibility to the ICI Sector

ISSUE

The Federation of Northern Ontario Municipalities (FONOM) is calling on the Province of Ontario to amend **Ontario Regulation 391/21: Blue Box** to ensure producers are fully responsible for the end-of-life management of their products and packaging **from all sources**, including the **Industrial, Commercial, and Institutional (ICI)** sectors.
While the current regulation requires producers to manage recyclable materials from designated *"eligible"* residential sources, it excludes significant waste streams generated in ICI settings such as municipal facilities, provincial government buildings, schools, hospitals, and other public institutions. As a result, these sectors must either absorb the cost of recycling or divert materials to landfill—placing additional strain on Ontario's already limited landfill capacity.
This regulatory gap undermines the principles of Extended Producer Responsibility and creates inequitable outcomes. For example, a beverage container recycled at home falls under producer responsibility, while the same container consumed at a government facility does not—shifting costs directly onto municipalities and taxpayers.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR NORTHERN ONTARIO

- **Limited landfill capacity**: Northern communities face higher transportation costs and fewer disposal options.
- **Public-sector cost pressure**: Municipalities and public institutions must fund recycling programs for materials identical to those covered in residential systems.
- **Inconsistent policy outcomes**: The point of consumption—not the product—determines responsibility, creating inefficiencies and inequities.

With new landfill siting increasingly costly, complex, and time-consuming, Ontario must prioritize **waste reduction and diversion** through a strengthened EPR framework.

Amending Ontario Regulation 391/21 to include ICI sources is a **policy-consistent, fiscally responsible, and environmentally sound** step that supports municipalities, protects landfill capacity, and strengthens Ontario's leadership in waste reduction.

FONOM represents 110 municipalities across Northern Ontario and remains committed to working collaboratively with the Province to build fair, sustainable, and practical environmental policy.

POWASSAN MAPLE SYRUP FESTIVAL
P. O. Box 250
250 Clark St.
Powassan, Ontario P0H 1Z0
www.powassanmaplesyrupfestival.ca

DONATIONS AND SPONSORSHIPS

We appreciate your generosity and are happy to accommodate your desire to have your donation put towards a specific event, if possible. Please indicate below your 1st, 2nd and 3rd choices for your contribution. If the 1st event you would like to sponsor already has enough contributions to cover, we will allocate your donation to your 2nd or 3rd choices or it will be put toward General Funds.

If you would like to put your business sign adjacent to the event you are sponsoring, please contact Kim at 705 724 2813, ext. 238 to discuss. **Please also send us a pdf of your business logo for our website**. Please send to kbester@powassan.net

Please return this form and your donation to:
250 Clark St., Powassan Ontario

(Donations can also be put in our drop box either outside or inside at 250 Clark). Please do not provide cash this way. Cheques should be made out to **THE MUNICIPALITY OF POWASSAN.**

PLEASE RESPOND BY MARCH 1ST if possible.

BUSINESS NAME: _____

CONTACT PERSON: _____

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CHOICE	EVENT	APPROXIMATE COST	DONATION AMOUNT
	GREAT CANADIAN LUMBERJACK SHOW	$5,300.00	
	KIDZ ZONE – PUPPET AND REPTILE SHOWS	$2,500.00	
	LIVE MUSICAL ENTERTAINMENT	$2,000.00	
	GENERAL FUNDS		

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From the Office of the Clerk
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February 6, 2026

Please be advised that during the regular Council meeting of January 29, 2026 the following resolution regarding support for Bill 21, Protect Our Food Act, 2025 was carried.

RESOLUTION NO. **2026-32**

DATE: **January 29, 2026**

MOVED BY: **Councillor Prinzen**

SECONDED BY: **Councillor MacNaughton**

WHEREAS arable land is a critical finite resource; and

WHEREAS Ontario has lost 2.8 million acres of farmland in the last three decades; and

WHEREAS Ontario loses as much as 319 acres of farmland a day; and

WHEREAS Ontario's farmland provides food, fiber and fuel to all of Ontario and beyond;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT the Council of the County of Prince Edward support Bill 21, Protect Our Food Act, 2025 and strongly urges the provincial government to support this and every measure to protect our farmland, to aggressively prevent further losses and to ensure the future of agriculture in Ontario for future generations; and

THAT a copy of this resolution be sent to the Premier of Ontario; the Minister of Agriculture, Food and Agribusiness, the Minister of the Environment, Conservation and Parks; Guelph MPP Mike Schreiner, Haldimand-Norfolk MPP Bobbi Ann Brady, Bay of Quinte MPP Tyler Allsopp, the Ontario Federation of Agriculture, the Association of Municipalities of Ontario, and all Municipalities in Ontario.

CARRIED

Yours truly,

Catalina Blumenberg, **CLERK**

cc: Mayor Steve Ferguson, Councillor Prinzen, Councillor Branderhorst

Municipality of Magnetawan

RESOLUTION NO. 2026- 20 **FEBRUARY 11, 2026**

Moved by: [signature]

Seconded by: Brad Kneller

WHEREAS reliable, high-speed internet access is essential infrastructure that supports economic development, housing construction, healthcare, education, municipal operations, and overall community well-being;

AND WHEREAS the Province of Ontario has recognized the importance of digital infrastructure through the *Accelerating Access to Broadband for Ontario Act, 2021*, which seeks to expand broadband access to all Ontarians, particularly in underserved and rural communities;

AND WHEREAS access to affordable high-speed internet is a necessary precondition to achieving provincial and federal housing, economic development, and population growth targets;

AND WHEREAS Bell Canada currently offers dedicated fibre internet services at the following indicative rates under a five (5) year term within a regulated area: 100 Mbps / 100 Mbps $1,010 per month, 500 Mbps / 500 Mbps $3,090 per month and 1 Gbps / 1 Gbps $3,250 per month.

AND WHEREAS such pricing structures place dedicated fibre services beyond the financial reach of many municipalities, small businesses, housing developments, non-profit organizations, and community facilities;

AND WHEREAS unaffordable broadband infrastructure costs undermine the intent of provincial and federal legislation aimed at universal access to high-speed internet, including federal programs administered by Innovation, Science and Economic Development Canada (ISED) and regulatory oversight by the Canadian Radio-television and Telecommunications Commission (CRTC);

AND WHEREAS affordable, high-speed internet access is essential infrastructure and a foundational requirement for inclusive growth, housing delivery, and community resilience and municipalities are required to plan for growth, housing, and economic competitiveness, yet have no say in telecommunications pricing and market structures;

AND WHEREAS the Council of the Municipality of Magnetawan calls upon the CRTC to examine the affordability of dedicated fibre pricing and its impact on municipal infrastructure, housing development, and equitable internet access;

AND WHEREAS the Council of the Municipality of Magnetawan calls upon the Government of Ontario to work with telecommunications providers to ensure that broadband infrastructure costs do not impede the objectives of the *Accelerating Access to Broadband for Ontario Act, 2021* and the *Building Faster Homes and More Choice Act, 2022*;

AND WHEREAS the Council of the Municipality of Magnetawan calls upon Bell Canada to review and revise its dedicated fibre pricing models to ensure they are affordable, transparent, and scaled appropriately for municipalities, community institutions, and local development projects;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT the Council of the Municipality of Magnetawan calls upon the Government of Canada, including ISED, to strengthen affordability requirements tied to federal broadband funding and universal access programs;

AND FURTHER THAT this resolution be circulated to the Prime Minister of Canada Mark Carney, the Honourable Premier Doug Ford, the Honourable Melanie Joly, Minister of Innovation, Science and Industry, the Honourable Kinga Surma, Minister of Infrastructure, the Honourable Rob Flack, Minister of Municipal Affairs and Housing, the Honourable Graydon Smith, MPP for Parry Sound–Muskoka, the Honourable Scott Aitchison, MP for Parry Sound–Muskoka, Bell Canada, the CRTC, FONOM, AMO, NOMA, and all Ontario municipalities through AMCTO.

Carried ✓ Defeated_____ Deferred_____

[signature]
Sam Dunnett, Mayor

Recorded Vote Called by: _____

Recorded Vote

Member of Council	Yea	Nay	Absent
Bishop, Bill			
Hetherington, John			
Hind, Jon			
Kneller, Brad			
Mayor: Dunnett, Sam			